Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, May 15, 2023

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower
Regrets:	Regional Councillor	J. Dies

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Deputy Mayor Crawford called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

Deputy Mayor Crawford noted that Mayor Collier will be absent for a portion of the meeting as he is attending a graduation ceremony for 13 new Durham Regional Police Service (DRPS) recruits.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on April 17, 2023 be adopted.
CARRIED

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the minutes of the Closed Meeting of Council held on April 17, 2023 be adopted.
CARRIED

4. Question Period

Deputy Mayor Crawford noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. Jason McWilliam, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, noted that no questions had been received regarding the contents of the meeting agenda.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.1 Delegation: South Ajax Community Safety and Cleanliness

Tameka Mercurius, South Ajax Resident, expressed concerns regarding safety and cleanliness around the area of Commercial Avenue between Station Street and Bayly Avenue. T. Mercurius noted that the area is mixed-use development bordered by private property. T. Mercurius reviewed strategies to support a safe and clean community namely accountability, a safety and cleanliness plan, community investment and development, reduced speed limits, and opportunities to collaborate with the Town of Ajax.

Council Members asked questions regarding improvements and collaborative efforts to date. T. Mercurius responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Deputy Mayor Crawford thanked T. Mercurius for her delegation.

5.2 **Delegation & Proclamation: Neurofibromatosis Awareness**

In the absence of presenters Neveah Sosa and Nicole Goudreau, Neurofibromatosis Ontario, the proclamation certificate will be forwarded to the organization.

5.3 **Delegation & Proclamation: Aging Well Month**

Moninder Nahar, Community Recreation Supervisor – Senior Programs & Services, noted that June marks the 39th anniversary of Seniors Month in Ontario, coined Aging Well Month, and recognized the role and contributions that older adults and seniors play in our community. M. Nahar introduced Patricia Bolger, Member of Recreation & Culture Older Adult Task Force, who reviewed upcoming activities for the month of June, including the annual Seniors Barbecue. P. Bolger acknowledged the Ministry of Seniors and Accessibility for their ongoing support through the Seniors Active Living Centre funding. P. Bolger introduced Nadia Singh, Member of the Recreation & Culture Older Adult Task Force, who reviewed virtual and in person events for the month of June. Nadia introduced Elaine Lievaart, Community Engagement Associate – Ajax Public Library, who reviewed upcoming events and activities at the Ajax Public Library for the month of June. M. Nahar requested that Ajax Council proclaim June, 2023 as Aging Well Month in the Town of Ajax.

Deputy Mayor Crawford presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed June 2023 as Aging Well Month in the Town of Ajax.

5.4 **Delegation & Proclamation: National AccessAbility Week 2023**

Sepelene Deonarine, Accessibility Advisory Committee (AAC) Chair, discussed the mandate of the AAC, the importance of National AccessAbility Week, and accessibility awareness and education. Tarak Ahmed, Accessibility Advisory Committee Member, reviewed interactive events and activities occurring during National AccessAbility Week in the Town of Ajax. T. Ahmed requested that Ajax Council proclaim May 28 – June 3, 2023 as National AccessAbility Week in the Town of Ajax.

Deputy Mayor Crawford presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed May 28 – June 3, 2023 as National AccessAbility Week in the Town of Ajax.

5.5 **Presentation: Lakeridge Health Update for Council**

Cynthia Davis, President and CEO, Lakeridge Health, delivered a presentation regarding updates to Lakeridge Health. C. Davis discussed the new state-of-the-art surgical centre, improving access to long-term care, meeting a growing population, Ajax Pickering Hospital redevelopment, emergency department revitalization, increasing access to primary care highlighting the New Queen's-Lakeridge Health MD Family Medicine Program, and community partnerships. C. Davis expressed thanks to Town of Ajax Council and staff for their support.

Council Members asked questions regarding emergency department revitalization and health equity resources, opportunities to implement a fast-track walk-in-clinic to accommodate residents who don't have a family doctor, emergency department diversion programs, opportunities to partner with Ontario Shores Centre for Mental Health Sciences, and services provided by the Jerry Coughlan Health & Wellness Centre. C. Davis responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Deputy Mayor Crawford thanked C. Davis for her presentation.

5.6 **Presentation: Metrolinx GO Expansion Update**

Jake Schabas, Head Sponsor, GO Expansion, Metrolinx, provided an update regarding the Metrolinx GO Expansion. J. Schabas reviewed improvements across the GTHA, GO expansion programs, on-corridor works, Ajax GO station improvements including tractical yellow safety tiles, new digital signage, upgraded elevators and increased service levels, the Bowmanville extension project including benefits and proposed service levels and next steps, transit oriented communities, and community engagement.

Council Members asked questions regarding opportunities for fare reductions, express services, timelines associated with the installation of bike storage/lockers and improvements at the Ajax GO Station, timelines associated with the Bowmanville project, and status of high frequency (15 minute) services including community engagement strategies with Durham Region Transit. J. Schabas responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Deputy Mayor Crawford thanked J. Schabas for his presentation.

5.7 **Presentation: 2023 Town of Ajax Community Survey**

Victoria Sicilia, Director, Consultation and Engagement, Environics Research, delivered a presentation regarding the 2023 Town of Ajax Community Survey. V. Sicilia reviewed polling results in the following categories: satisfaction with the Town of Ajax, areas of concern, service delivery, perceptions of the Town of Ajax, contacts, communication, and community safety. V. Sicilia noted that residents allocate the most importance for the Ajax Partnership Fund to support community safety and wellbeing, seniors, and youth.

Mayor Collier entered the meeting at 8:29 p.m.

Council Members asked questions regarding opportunities to circulate the survey findings to Department Heads and community stakeholders, survey sample details including geographic distribution, survey participants, and rationale for why residents are more supportive of increases to property taxes than previous years. Liam Nichols, Grants & Strategic Initiatives Coordinator and V. Sicilia, responded to questions from Council Members.

With the consent of Members present, item 7.4.1 was advanced in the order business.

7.4 **Departmental Reports**

7.4.1. **CAO-2023-10: 2023 Town of Ajax Community Survey**

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: N. Henry

That Council receive the report entitled “2023 Town of Ajax Community Survey” for information.

CARRIED

6. Correspondence

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: S. Collier

That the report dated May 15, 2023 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1. **Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report**

7.1.1 **Community Affairs & Planning Committee, May 1, 2023**

None

7.2. **General Government Committee Report**

7.2.1 **General Government Committee, May 8, 2023**

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the General Government Committee Report dated May 8, 2023 be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 **Summary of Advisory Committee Activities**

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated May 15, 2023, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 **Departmental Reports**

7.4.2. **FIN-2023-12: Banking Signing Officers**

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the bank signing officers for the Town of Ajax be updated to include title only as follows:

Elected Officers

Mayor
3 Regional Councillors

Appointed Officials

Director of Finance/Treasurer
Manager of Budgets & Accounting Services
Manager of Taxation
Manager of Procurement

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

None.

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 **Flag Raising Requests**

Regional Councillor Lee and Councillor Tyler Morin introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

WHEREAS the Town provides opportunity for flag raisings to acknowledge recognition of national and independence days, art, community and cultural events and celebrations, charitable fundraising/public awareness campaigns, civic events, and other celebrations and commemorations recognized by the Ontario Provincial Legislature;

AND WHEREAS a formal operating procedure (LIS-WI-026) is in place to recognize the steps to approve or deny flag raising requests, and hold formal ceremonies as requested;

AND WHEREAS flag raisings are considered as Town-run events and the contents of the associated programming should align with the beliefs and values of the Council and the Town;

THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

The Office of the CAO, in consultation with Legislative and Information Services, update the Town's operating procedure for Flag Raising Requests to:

i. differentiate the criteria for raising flags at Ajax Town Hall from Pat Bayly Square;
ii. establish guidelines for flag raising ceremonies and photos opportunities, and
iii. ensure the appropriate oversight of flag raising programming by the Diversity and Inclusion Coordinator

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Members of Council asked questions regarding the Part Lot Control Exemption Extension (John Boddy Homes) By-law and the Election Sign By-law. Stev Andis, Manager of Planning and Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: S. Collier

That By-law numbers 21-2023 to 27-2023 be read a first, second and third time and passed.
CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities including a community Ward 1 meeting on May 30, 2023, Drag Queen Storytime on June 10, 2023 at Ajax Library, Asian Gold Ribbon Day on May 20, 2023, Quizzes and Cocktails at St. Francis Centre on May 26, 2023, a food security event courtesy of Durham Community Action Group located at 577 Kingston Road W., and community Ward 3 planting opportunities on May 27, 2023 at Ajax Porte Road, June 3, 2023 at Aldonschool Court and June 17, 2023 at St. Andrews Park.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier congratulated the 13 new DRPS recruits.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: S. Collier

That By-law number 28-2023 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on May 15, 2023, be read a first, second and third time and passed.
CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the May 15, 2023 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (8:55 p.m.)
CARRIED

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Mayor

_____
D-Clerk